Abdullah Al Zahid

Toronto, ON | (780) 982-3680 | azahid1@ualberta.ca | linkedin.com/in/abdullah-al-zahid

October 13, 2026

Talent Acquisition
Mott MacDonald, Toronto, ON

Re: Project Manager

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Project Manager position in Toronto. I worked at Mott MacDonald briefly in early 2023, where I ran Synchro traffic simulations of Ontario Line construction staging and road closures and prepared the supporting material for the project team. Since then I have worked in GO rail service design at Metrolinx and, since January 2024, as an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto.

At the City I run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, planning the work, holding the schedule and quality myself, and reporting progress to the people relying on it. I coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and I write the briefing notes and presentations that carry issues and options to senior staff.

At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services and assessed what temporary and permanent slow orders, the kind of restriction construction on an operating railway imposes, would do to service. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. The posting asks for five to ten years of project management on infrastructure projects. My project management has been of studies, not delivery: I have not managed an infrastructure project's schedule and commercial objectives, change control or project controls, and I have not led or managed staff. I am not a member of PMI and do not hold a PMP.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

Abdullah Al Zahid